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UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
CENTRAL DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA
Case No. 5:25-cv-02931-SRM-DTB

NICHOLAS A. VENTURA v. RANDSTAD US LLC, et al.
MEET-AND-CONFER CHRONOLOGY (LOCAL RULE 7-3)

I. Purpose and Scope

This chronology traces every identified party-to-party communication in the record bearing on the Local Rule 7-3 / Civil Standing Order (Dkt. 16) meet-and-confer requirement, from the first pre-removal contact (October 16, 2025) through Plaintiff's formal cure correspondence of March 18, 2026. It is organized to support (a) the LR 7-3 compliance statements required in Plaintiff's refiled motions, and (b) any argument addressing the Court's March 17, 2026 finding that no compliant conference occurred on the three struck motions.

Governing standard: Local Rule 7-3 requires the moving party to contact opposing counsel "to discuss thoroughly, preferably in person, the substance of the contemplated motion and any potential resolution" at least seven days before filing, and to include a compliance statement in the notice of motion. C.D. Cal. R. 7-3. The Court's Civil Standing Order (Dkt. 16 at 12–13) layers an additional, stricter requirement specific to this case: the conference must occur by videoconference or in person — "Email correspondence alone is insufficient."

II. Chronological Table

Date	Actor(s)	Method	Substance	Compliance Significance
10/16/25	John Ly (Korn Ferry counsel) → Plaintiff	Overnight letter	Ly requests Plaintiff voluntarily dismiss Korn Ferry, asserting no involvement in the alleged fraud/crypto sale.	Pre-removal contact; not a Rule 7-3 conference (no motion pending).
11/3/25	Korn Ferry (Ly) → Plaintiff	Written LR 7-3 letter (per Ly Decl. ¶¶4–5, Ex. A)	Same day as Notice of Removal, Ly sends a detailed meet-and-confer letter re: anticipated Motion to Dismiss and offers dates/times to confer.	Defendant-initiated LR 7-3 outreach on the MTD track.
11/3/25	Plaintiff → Ly (per Ly Decl. ¶5, Ex. B)	Email	Plaintiff states he needs additional time to prepare a response and declines all proposed conference dates. Ly states no further call or email followed from Plaintiff on the MTD.	Sworn defense account: conference proposed by Defendant, declined by Plaintiff, not rescheduled.
11/3/25	Windy Thor (KCOz) → Plaintiff	Email	Requests that Chapman and Williams be cc'd on all future filings/correspondence.	Administrative — sets correspondence protocol, not a 7-3 conference.
10/17/25	Plaintiff ↔ John Ly	Email exchange	Plaintiff declines to consent to email service under CRC 2.251/CCP 1010.6; states matter should "be evaluated in court"; notes ADR "still open…but not likely."	Service-method dispute; touches ADR posture but not a motion-specific conference.

11/10/25	Liang Ly LLP (Leilani Sui) → Plaintiff	Courtesy email + overnight mail	Serves Korn Ferry MTD, supporting Ly declaration, and proposed order.	Notice of motion filing — triggers the LR 7-3 clock for any Plaintiff-side motion practice, not itself a conference.
11/25/25	Windy Thor (KCOz) → Plaintiff	Email	Serves Randstad's Notice of Supplement to Korn Ferry's Notice of Removal.	Administrative filing notice only.
12/4–17/25	Plaintiff ↔ John Ly	Email exchange	Discussion of settlement/ADR framework; Plaintiff expresses openness to arbitration; Ly reports MTD noticed for 1/28/26; Plaintiff discloses mental-health considerations and requests care in tone.	Settlement-track correspondence (FRE 408); not a Rule 7-3 conference on a specific pending motion.
12/16–21/25	Plaintiff ↔ Nathan Chapman (KCOz)	Email (marked FRE 408 settlement communication)	Plaintiff submits confidential settlement demand; Chapman rejects it as "entirely detached from reality."	Settlement-track only; no LR 7-3 statement generated.
1/6/26	Windy Thor (KCOz) → all parties	Email	Serves Randstad's Notice of Joinder to Korn Ferry's Motion to Dismiss.	Administrative filing notice.
1/28/26	Windy Thor (KCOz) → Plaintiff	Email	Serves Randstad's Notice of Joinder to Opposition to Plaintiff's Motion for Leave to Amend.	Administrative filing notice.
1/28/26	Plaintiff → Windy Thor, cc Chapman/Williams	Email	Plaintiff acknowledges Defendants' opposition to the amendment motion and states he intends to proceed on the existing filing. First express request: "I would appreciate scheduling a meet-and-confer to discuss whether separate or joint case management statements would be most efficient."	Plaintiff-initiated request to confer — directed at CMC logistics, not framed as an LR 7-3 statement tied to a specific pending motion.
2/5/26	Plaintiff ↔ Chad Williams (KCOz)	Email scheduling a phone call	Williams asks Plaintiff to "give me a quick call" before filing anything re: the Notice of Joinder issue; parties exchange availability (7:43–10:45 AM) and a call is arranged for later that morning.	A telephone call occurred on the Joinder/service issue — method-compliant in form (not email-only), but not tied to a specific motion's LR 7-3 statement and predates the Standing Order's videoconference-or-in-person requirement being invoked.

2/12/26	Plaintiff ↔ John Ly	Email ("Urgent" thread)	Plaintiff requests to "meet ahead of issuing a motion to compel on interrogatories" regarding discovery/investigative-tool requests; Ly responds, "Let me know what you would like to confer about."	Plaintiff-initiated request to confer on anticipated discovery motion; exchange does not show a completed videoconference/in-person conference or resulting LR 7-3 statement.
2/21/26	Plaintiff → Ly, Chapman	Email	Plaintiff raises CMC statement alignment, subpoena strategy, and states he "will follow up again about CMC."	Preparatory correspondence; no conference completed.
3/10/26	Plaintiff	Ex parte filing (Dkt. 41)	Plaintiff files Ex Parte Application for Leave to Proceed In Forma Pauperis.	Not an LR 7-3 motion, but part of the same compliance pattern addressed by the Court below.
3/11/26	Court (Hon. Serena R. Murillo)	Order (Dkt. 42)	Court STRIKES the Ex Parte IFP Application for failure to comply with C.D. Cal. R. 7-19, 7-19.1, and 83-2.2.3 (no contact information for opposing party; no good-faith notice efforts documented).	Judicial finding of local-rule non-compliance — distinct rule (7-19), but establishes the pattern the Court later cites.
3/14/26	Plaintiff → SRM Chambers, cc counsel	Email	Plaintiff transmits a proposed order regarding the early third-party subpoena motion (Dkt. 39/40) and requests a ruling or notice.	Direct-to-chambers correspondence; not a party-to-party meet-and-confer.
3/16/26	Plaintiff → Ly, Chapman, Newell	Email	Brief follow-up ("FYI… may be outside of my range after the second hop") forwarding the 3/14 chambers email.	No substantive conference content.
3/17/26	Court (Hon. Serena R. Murillo)	Order (Dkt. 44)	Court STRIKES Plaintiff's Motion to Remand (Dkt. 11), Motion to Amend Complaint (Dkt. 24), and Motion for Leave to Serve Early Third-Party Subpoenas (Dkt. 39) for failure to conform with LR 7-3 and the Civil Standing Order (Dkt. 16 at 12–13). Court expressly finds Plaintiff filed all three motions "without including a statement articulating that the parties met and conferred or that he attempted to contact Defendants prior to filing." Court reiterates: conference must be by videoconference or in person — "Email correspondence is insufficient" — and that pro se litigants must comply with the Local Rules under C.D. Cal. R. 83-2.2.3.	Central judicial finding: as of 3/17/26, no LR 7-3–compliant conference (videoconference or in-person) had occurred on any of the three struck motions, and no compliant statement was filed.
3/17/26	Chad Williams (KCOz) → SRM Chambers, cc Plaintiff	Email	Asks whether the 4/1/26 hearing is proceeding given the (already-struck) unopposed motion; requests remote appearance.	Scheduling inquiry; overtaken by the same-day striking order.

3/17/26	Plaintiff → Chad Williams, cc Chapman/Newell /Ly	Email	Confirms intent to proceed with the 4/1/26 hearing date; no objection to remote appearance.	Scheduling response only.
3/18/26	Plaintiff → Williams, Chapman, Newell, Ly	Formal LR 7-3 email initiating conference	Plaintiff expressly invokes LR 7-3 and the Standing Order (Dkt. 16) to cure the 3/17/26 striking as to the two motions he intends to refile: Motion for Leave to Amend (formerly Dkt. 24) and Motion for Leave to Serve Early Third-Party Subpoenas (formerly Dkt. 39). Acknowledges the Standing Order requires videoconference or in-person conference — "email correspondence alone has proven insufficient in this case" — and proposes ten specific videoconference time blocks between 3/19/26 and 3/25/26. Requests confirmation of availability by COB Friday, 3/20/26, and states he will accurately represent the status of meet-and-confer efforts in any future filing.	First fully LR 7-3–conforming written initiation in the record: correct legal standard cited, specific videoconference dates offered, deadline for response set, and express intent to document compliance (or non-compliance) in the refiled motions.

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III. Key Findings

1. Two distinct compliance tracks appear in the record. On the Korn Ferry Motion to Dismiss track, Defendant Korn Ferry (through Mr. Ly) affirmatively initiated an LR 7-3 conference by letter on November 3, 2025, offering specific dates; Plaintiff's response (by Ly's sworn account) requested more time and declined the offered dates, and no further contact followed from Plaintiff on that specific motion. This places the compliance gap, if any exists for that motion, on a materially different footing than the later-struck motions — the record reflects a defense-initiated, motion-specific offer rather than silence on both sides.

2. On the Motion to Remand (Dkt. 11), Motion to Amend (Dkt. 24), and Early Subpoena Motion (Dkt. 39), the Court found on March 17, 2026 that Plaintiff filed all three without any statement of a completed conference or even a documented attempt to contact Defendants beforehand. The pre-filing record here shows scattered, informal references to conferring (e.g., the January 28, 2026 request to "schedul[e] a meet-and-confer," the February 12, 2026 request to "meet ahead of issuing a motion to compel," and the February 5, 2026 phone call tied to the Joinder/service dispute) — but none of these is tied to a specific motion's LR 7-3 statement, none documents a completed videoconference or in-person conference on the substance of the Remand, Amendment, or Subpoena motions specifically, and none produced the required compliance recital in the filed papers.

3. The March 18, 2026 email is the first document in the record that (a) correctly identifies the Standing Order's videoconference-or-in-person requirement, (b) proposes specific videoconference time blocks tied to the two motions being refiled, and (c) sets a firm response deadline while reserving the right to represent the status of the conference accurately in the refiled motions. This is the appropriate template for demonstrating good-faith compliance going forward and for documenting any Defendant non-response as a basis for the required "explain the refusal in detail" showing under the Standing Order.

4. Recommendation: any refiled motion (Amendment, Early Subpoenas) should attach this chronology or a condensed version of it as an exhibit to the LR 7-3 compliance statement, and should quote the operative Standing Order language (Dkt. 16 at 12–13) verbatim in the notice of motion, consistent with the Court's March 17, 2026 order.